

Andrea Neyra Nazarrett

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RESEARCH INTEREST

Labor Economics, Personnel Economics, Economic Development, Political Economy.

EDUCATION

Harvard University

Cambridge MA, 2021-2027 (expected)

PhD in Political Economy and Government, Economics track.

Harvard University Kennedy School of Government

Cambridge MA, 2021

Master in Public Policy. Fulbright-Garcia Robles Scholar.

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM)

Mexico City, Mexico 2018

Bachelor's degree in Economics. Graduated with the Highest Honors.

PREVIOUS WORK AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

World Bank

Washington DC, March 2020–May 2021

Consultant in the Macroeconomics and Growth Team. Dev Research Group

Inter-American Development Bank (IADB).

Mexico City, Mexico March 2018–Sept 2019

Consultant at the Fiscal and Municipal Management Division

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Training Within Firms

Brayan Diaz, Andrea Neyra-Nazarrett, Julian Ramirez, Raffaella Sadun, Jorge Tamayo

This paper explores the organizational frictions that hinder training implementation within firms, focusing on the role of middle managers. Using data from three large Latin American firms—a car manufacturer, a quick-service restaurant chain, and a retailer—we show that middle managers who promote employee development boost training take-up and improve performance. Managerial rotations and event study methods reveal that “High Training” managers increase participation by up to 60%. The findings underscore the importance of embedding managerial behavior into human capital policy design.

An Anatomy of Managerial Attention: Evidence from Retail

Achyuta Adhvaryu, Parker Howell, Andrea Neyra-Nazarrett, Anant Nyshadham, Jorge Tamayo

This study examines how managerial attention to complexity drives productivity in a large Colombian retail firm. High-performing managers reduce stockouts, streamline inventory, simplify product assortments, and improve pricing. Manager arrival leads to staffing changes toward sales, pricing, and inventory roles. Using AKM fixed effects and survey data, we document specific behavioral and organizational responses that explain performance variation in complex operational settings.

VAT Holidays as Short-Term Economic Stimuli: The Case of Colombia's “Días sin IVA”

José Martínez-Carrasco, David Muñoz, Andrea Neyra-Nazarrett, Alejandro Rasteletti, Diego Zamora

We evaluate Colombia's VAT holiday policy (2020–2022) using 1.3 billion Bancolombia transactions. A repeated regression discontinuity design finds a 14% increase in sales during DSI events, with durable goods like electronics experiencing the highest gains. Effects are strongest among stores serving low-income consumers. Results highlight the stimulus potential of well-designed, broad-based tax holidays in emerging economies.

IN PROGRESS

Managing Shrinkage (with Jorge Tamayo)

Investigates how personnel allocation and management strategies reduce inventory shrinkage in retail firms. Using data from supermarkets in Mexico and Colombia, it analyzes how managerial oversight affects losses due to theft, waste, and inefficiencies. The findings contribute to the literature on operational efficiency and firm profitability.

A New Test for The Efficiency Wage Hypothesis: The Case of Retail in Mexico (Solo-authored)

This research examines the impact of wage premia on firm performance, using data from a large Mexican retailer with 400+ stores and 100,000 workers. It explores how comparative wages and minimum wage benchmarks influence worker productivity, contributing to the efficiency wage literature.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Harvard University – Division of Continuous Education (DCE)

Teaching Fellow, [Survey Research Methods](#) (2022–2025)

Teaching Fellow Advanced Research Methods for Social Science(2022–2025)

Harvard University – Faculty of Arts and Sciences (FAS)

Teaching Fellow, [Advanced Quantitative Methods: Causal Inference](#) (2023–2025)

Teaching Fellow, [Economics of Discontinuous Change \(Econ 1818\)](#) (2024–2025)

Harvard Kennedy School

Tutor, [Quantitative Analysis and Empirical Methods](#) (2025)

Course Coach, [Environmental Politics: Negotiation, Persuasion, and Leadership \(IGA-455\)](#) (2021)

Teaching Fellow, [The Politics of Development \(DPI-410\)](#) (2021)

Teaching Fellow, [Public Finance in the International Perspective \(DEV-215\)](#) (2020)

Teaching Assistant, [Advanced Markets and Market Failure \(API-101Z\)](#) (2019)

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND HONORS

Griffin Fellowship for Political Development	2023
Colombia Santo Domingo Research Fund	2024
DRCLAS Summer Fellowship	2023-
Mildred Rendl PhD 1954 Graduate Student	2024
Fellow Fulbright-Garcia Robles	2019-
Scholarship	2021
Harvard Ash Center for Democratic Governance and Innovation. Research Project	2020
Fellowship	
Harvard Kennedy School of Government Summer Research	2020
Fellowship.	2019
Comecyt Talent and Excellence Scholarship	2019
Conacyt -FUNED Scholarship	2019
Dionisio Medina Harvard	2021
Scholarship	2019

CONFERENCES CO-ORGANIZED

The MX Conference at the Harvard Kennedy School 2021.	Co-Chair	2021
The MX Conference 2020	Co-Organizer	2020

SKILLS

Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Proficient), German (Limited Proficiency).

Software: Proficient in Stata, Python, R.

General: Marathon runner and open waters long-distance swimmer.

